THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE GRAIN SUPPLY SHOCK THESIS

Scarcity Without A Windfall

Chicago wheat settled at 784 cents a bushel on Friday, its highest since February 2023 and a gain of 12.1 per cent on the week — the largest weekly move since March 2022. Corn reached a three-year high above $5.40. The causes are physical and datable: Ukrainian drone strikes suspended all three grain terminals at Novorossiysk from 12 August, and drought cut the French wheat crop to roughly 32 million tonnes. Yet in the same month one of the world's largest fertiliser producers reported a $273 million quarterly net loss, and the largest farm machinery manufacturer reported that its core agricultural segment shrank 6 per cent. The question is not whether grain is scarce. It is why the scarcity is not arriving where the map says it should.

A reframe worth holding onto

A grain price is not farm income, and farm income is not agricultural equity earnings. They are three separate quantities on three separate clocks. A supply shock lifts the first, redistributes the second inside the sector rather than expanding it, and may not touch the third at all. Collapsing the three into one misprices the sector at exactly the moments it looks most obvious.

This reframe is editorial, assembled from external reporting. The internal Wiki was unreachable for this edition.

Method. External figures come from company results releases and earnings calls, exchange settlement reporting, USDA Economic Research Service forecasts, and dated news reporting; each carries an as-of date at the point of use. Internal figures would ordinarily come from the Heyokha research Wiki, attributed to the named provider and labelled as a view rather than a forecast. **The Wiki MCP server was not available in this run.** This edition therefore rests entirely on the external leg, and asserts no internal claim anywhere in it.

A late frost runs through one valley of a wine region in May, destroying roughly a third of the region's crop. By autumn the price of a case has doubled. Three parties watch that same number. The growers in the frosted valley have almost nothing to sell; they receive the doubled price on a fraction of a normal harvest and end the year poorer than they began it. The growers one ridge over, untouched, sell a full crop at twice the money and end the year rich. And the cooperage at the bottom of the hill — which sells oak barrels, a capital item with a ten-year life — takes not one additional order, because no vintner commits a decade of capital on the strength of a frost that happened to somebody else. One price, three outcomes, and only one of them is the outcome the price appeared to promise.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

784c

Chicago wheat settlement per bushel, up 3.1 per cent on the day and 12.1 per cent on the week — the biggest weekly gain since March 2022, and the highest level since 14 February 2023. Up 54.5 per cent year to date.
Exchange settlement reporting, 28 August 2026.

−6%

Change in Deere's Production and Precision Agriculture net sales, to $3.998 billion, in the quarter ended 2 August 2026, on lower volumes in South America and Europe. The company's earnings beat came from construction.
Deere Q3 FY2026 results, 21 August 2026.

>50%

Market-implied probability of a Federal Reserve rate *increase* at the 15–16 September meeting after Chair Kevin Warsh's Jackson Hole remarks. The odds had been roughly one in three beforehand.
Reported market pricing, 28 August 2026.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

A logistics event wearing the costume of a shortage

On the night of 11–12 August, Ukrainian drones struck the Black Sea port of Novorossiysk. Three people were killed. The Novorossiysk Grain Terminal, rated at 8.5 million tonnes of annual export capacity, suspended operations; by 13 August all three of the port's grain terminals, including the dominant KSK facility, had stopped work. Russia is the world's largest wheat exporter, and reporting at the time put as much as a third of Russian grain exports through that single port. Together Russia and Ukraine account for more than a quarter of world wheat exports. The attack did not destroy a single bushel. It removed the door through which the wheat leaves.

That distinction matters more than it first appears. A destroyed crop is gone; a blocked port is a queue. The grain behind the blockage still exists and still needs to be sold, which places the shortage at the loading berth rather than in the ground. Prices cannot make that distinction on the day: the exchange prices the bushel deliverable against the contract, and in August the number of deliverable bushels fell sharply while the number of growing bushels did not. Running underneath was a second, slower shortfall that is real crop loss rather than logistics. France's agriculture ministry indicated 2026 wheat production near 32 million tonnes, close to 7 per cent below the previous year, with drought also reported across Germany, Romania and Poland, while US corn conditions slipped to 57 per cent good to excellent in late-August crop progress reporting. This is why the rally did not fade when repair work began.

But the complex that looks uniformly bullish from a distance is highly uneven up close. Wheat is up 54.5 per cent year to date; corn and soybeans roughly 22 per cent each. Soybeans, at about $12.64 for the September contract on 28 August and the highest since May 2024, moved partly on Chinese buying — a 333,000-tonne purchase was announced on 26 August — which is a demand story, not a supply one. One crop is responding to a war, another to weather, a third to a buyer. These have different half-lives, and the equities attached to them have discriminated between those half-lives with more care than the headline suggests.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A price that rises because supply was destroyed is not the same signal as a price that rises because demand appeared. The first *redistributes* income inside the sector — from the farmer who lost the crop to the farmer who did not. The second *expands* it. Both print the same number on the same screen. Only one of them funds a capital cycle.

THE MECHANISM

One bushel, four hands

1 · The field

Supply is removed, not created. A drought-hit hectare in the Beauce or a blocked berth at Novorossiysk produces no sellable bushel. The grower carrying the loss earns nothing on it at any price.

→

2 · The board

Chicago prices the marginal bushel that can still be delivered. Wheat settles at 784c, up 12.1 per cent on the week. The exchange move is instant and visible to everyone.

→

3 · The farm gate

Only unaffected acres capture the move, and only on tonnage not already sold forward. Basis, storage and prior hedges absorb much of the rest. The gate price lags the board by a season.

→

4 · The shelf

Farm value is about 16 cents of the consumer food dollar, 24 cents at grocery. A 20 per cent commodity rise adds at most four to five cents per grocery dollar, arriving three to six months later.

Steps 1–2: Novorossiysk terminal suspensions reported 12–13 August 2026; wheat settlement per exchange reporting, 28 August 2026. Step 4: farm share of the consumer food dollar and pass-through lag per USDA Economic Research Service and Purdue University Center for Commercial Agriculture analysis, 2026. Step 3 describes standard grain marketing mechanics and is not a quantified claim.

The fourth step is where the macro question sits. Because the farm captures only about sixteen cents of every consumer food dollar, and because the lag from futures to shelf runs three to six months — up to twelve for stored, flour-based and canned goods — a grain spike in late August is a first-quarter-2027 consumer price event, not a September one. That is inconvenient timing. On 28 August at Jackson Hole, Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh said underlying inflation trends had not meaningfully improved, adding that the Committee must be confident inflation is moving to target "clearly and at sufficient speed" and that "otherwise, we have work to do". Market-implied odds of a rise at the 15–16 September meeting moved from roughly one in three to above evens.

So the food-price consequence of the Black Sea will land after the decision currently being priced, and at a magnitude — four or five cents on the grocery dollar at most — that is real but modest against the categories actually driving the Fed's concern. A reader looking for the grain shock to force the Fed's hand in September will not find it there. A reader looking for it to complicate the disinflation narrative in the first half of 2027 has a better case.

+12.1%

Chicago wheat's gain in the week to 28 August 2026 — its largest weekly move since March 2022, and the clearest evidence that the physical disruption is being taken seriously by the market that prices it.

−$273m

The Mosaic Company's net loss in the quarter ended 30 June 2026, on revenue of $2.8 billion, with sulphur availability and production curtailments cited. A fertiliser producer losing money inside a grain bull market.

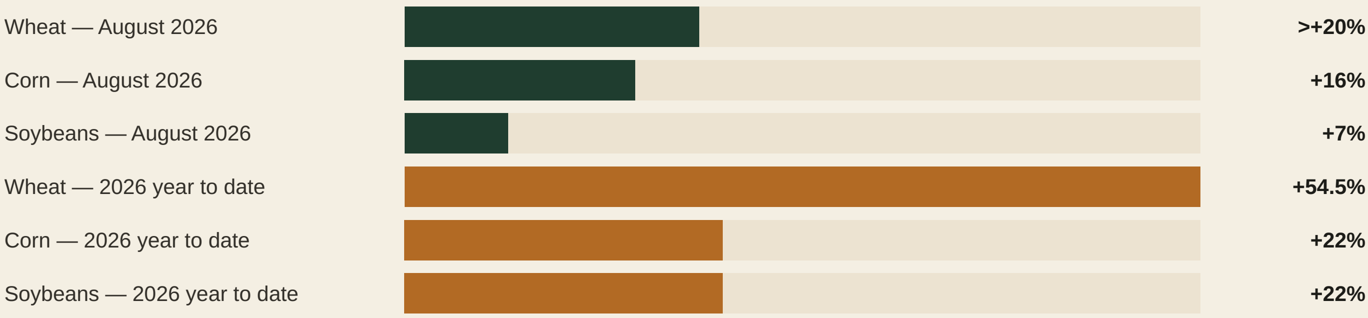
16 cents

The farm's share of every dollar an American consumer spends on food — 24 cents at the grocery store. The ceiling on how much a commodity move can matter at the till, before any lag.

Wheat: exchange settlement reporting, 28 August 2026. Mosaic: Q2 2026 results, reported August 2026 (revenue $2.8bn, operating loss $36m, net loss $273m, adjusted EBITDA $407m). Farm share: USDA Economic Research Service.

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

The rally is narrower than the phrase implies



Price changes as reported for the period to 28 August 2026. Bars are illustrative and drawn to a common scale (longest bar = 54.5 per cent); they are not precise measurement. All six series are percentage price changes, so the comparison is like-for-like, but the two time windows should not be added together.

Read down that chart and the "agricultural inflation" framing weakens. Wheat — the crop with direct Black Sea export exposure — has moved roughly two and a half times as far this year as the other two, each of which has an identifiable cause of its own having little to do with Novorossiysk. An investor buying the sector because grain is up is buying a portfolio in which one holding responds to a war and the other two to the weather and to Chinese purchasing. A second qualifier is obscured by the percentages entirely: wheat at 784 cents is a three-year high, not a historic one, and traded far higher in March 2022. The complex is recovering from a deep bear market during which farm input costs did not deflate symmetrically. A three-year high in the output price, set against costs that never returned to their own three-year lows, produces a much smaller margin recovery than the headline percentage implies.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Think of the grain complex as three clocks running at different speeds. The *exchange clock* moves in hours and responds to news. The *farm-gate clock* moves with the harvest and the hedge book, in seasons. The *capital-goods clock* moves with a farmer's belief about the next decade — and it does not start on a headline, however large the number attached to it.

WHAT HAS ACTUALLY SHIFTED

Five changes, each cutting in two directions

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Black Sea export capacity is physically impaired	All three Novorossiysk grain terminals suspended from 12–13 August 2026; NZT alone rated at 8.5 million tonnes a year; up to a third of Russian grain exports route through the port.	Verifiable and immediate, which supports the price. But terminals are repairable and the grain behind them is not destroyed, so the shortage can reverse with no change in the underlying balance.
Northern Hemisphere yields have genuinely fallen	French wheat production near 32 million tonnes, down close to 7 per cent year on year; drought in Germany, Romania and Poland; US corn conditions at 57 per cent good to excellent.	Crop loss is durable where logistics is not, and cannot be repaired within the marketing year. But it is localised: the growers who suffered the loss are precisely those who cannot sell into the higher price.
Nitrogen tightened for reasons unrelated to grain	CF Industries reported Q2 2026 net earnings of $727 million on net sales of $2.22 billion against $1.89 billion, citing a tight global nitrogen balance "further tightened by supply disruptions related to the conflict	Producers on cheap feedstock capture a genuine windfall. But the same energy shock raises the cost base for gas-disadvantaged producers, and dearer fertiliser tightens the affordability the grain rally was meant to loosen.

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
	with Iran". European TTF gas was near €69/MWh on 28 August.	
Farm income is supported by transfers, not prices	USDA ERS forecast 2026 net farm income at $153.4 billion, down 0.7 per cent nominally and lower in real terms, with direct government payments at $44.3 billion — up 45.2 per cent on 2025's $30.5 billion.	A transfer cushion stabilises solvency and therefore input demand. But it signals an underlying income problem, and the forecast dates from February 2026, before the August move, so it cannot be read as a current view.
The machinery cycle has not turned	Deere's Production and Precision Agriculture net sales fell 6 per cent to $3.998 billion in the quarter ended 2 August 2026; the beat and the raised full-year guidance of $4.75–5.00 billion rested on construction and small agriculture.	Management calling fiscal 2026 "likely the bottom" means any recovery starts from a low base. But it also confirms that eight months of rising grain prices produced no order response in the segment most sensitive to farm income.

THE TWO CASES

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **The impairment is physical, not sentimental.** Three named terminals at one port, suspended on a datable night, handling up to a third of the exports of the world's largest wheat exporter. This is a missing loading berth, not a risk premium.
- **The shortfall has multiple independent origins.** French production down roughly 7 per cent, drought across three further European producers, US corn conditions at 57 per cent good to excellent. A ceasefire would not repair the weather.
- **Fertiliser affordability improves mechanically.** Higher revenue per acre raises what a grower can pay for inputs next season. Global urea prices strengthened through the third quarter of 2026 after a seasonal second-quarter dip.
- **Volume, not just price, is holding up in potash.** Nutrien reported record potash sales volumes in the first half of 2026, with global shipments forecast at 74–77 million tonnes and markets described as constructive on affordability and stable supply.
- **Nitrogen tightness is underwritten beyond one cycle.** CF Industries raised its mid-cycle EBITDA target to $2.9 billion and expects nitrogen tightness through 2030, on first-half adjusted EBITDA of $2.18 billion and 98 per cent ammonia utilisation.
- **The equipment base is as low as management believes it goes.** Deere's own guidance frames fiscal 2026 as the trough. If grain strength persists into the 2027 planting decision, operating leverage meets a depressed starting point.

The bear case

- **A three-year high is not a historic high.** Wheat at 784 cents sits well below its March 2022 peak. The complex is exiting a bear market, and input costs did not fall symmetrically on the way down, so margin recovery lags price recovery badly.
- **The rally is narrow.** Wheat up 54.5 per cent year to date against roughly 22 per cent for corn and soybeans, on causes of their own. This is a Black Sea logistics event, not broad agricultural inflation, and should not be underwritten as one.
- **The capital-goods cycle did not respond.** Deere's core farming segment shrank 6 per cent in a quarter ending 2 August, after seven months of rising grain prices. The tractor order book is not a function of the front-month wheat contract.
- **Fertiliser earnings can fall while fertiliser prices rise.** Mosaic posted a $273 million net loss on $2.8 billion of revenue, with a $104 million operating loss in Phosphate on sulphur availability and curtailments, and cut capital expenditure to preserve liquidity. Nutrien's second-quarter earnings fell as higher benchmarks were more than offset by lower volumes and higher sulphur costs.
- **The processors' windfall came from oil, not grain.** Bunge attributed margin expansion to soybean oil following crude higher after Iran-related disruption; ADM cited renewable-fuel demand and ethanol. Higher grain input costs are a headwind to that engine, not its source.
- **The income picture was weak before the spike.** USDA's February 2026 forecast had net farm income falling in real terms, propped up by a 45 per cent rise in direct government payments. A rally arriving via crop failure does not obviously fix that.

WHERE THE EVIDENCE DISAGREES

An unresolved conflict

This edition cannot report a conflict between the internal Wiki view and external evidence, because the internal leg failed entirely. What can be reported is a sharp and unresolved conflict *within* the external record, and it is worth stating rather than smoothing over.

In early May 2026, sell-side commentary reported by Reuters framed the fertiliser complex as a clean split: nitrogen-focused producers such as CF Industries and Nutrien would outperform, while potash- and phosphate-weighted names such as Mosaic would struggle with sulphur and ammonia costs. The second half of that call was correct in direction — Mosaic did post a loss, and did cite sulphur. The first half was not. Nutrien's second-quarter earnings and adjusted EBITDA *fell* year on year despite higher global benchmarks, on lower volumes and higher sulphur costs of its own. CF Industries delivered $727 million of net earnings and a raised mid-cycle target, and still *missed* consensus, with pricing offsetting a 15 per cent volume decline and the shares slipping on the print. A framework built on the price of the product explained rather less than a framework built on the volume of it.

The second tension is between Deere's own words and its own numbers. Management described fiscal 2026 as likely the bottom of the agricultural equipment cycle and raised full-year guidance, and the shares rose sharply. Yet the segment that would express any such bottoming shrank 6 per cent, and the beat came from construction. Either the grain rally converts into machinery orders on the ordinary two-to-four-quarter lag and the guidance is early rather than wrong, or a war-driven price is precisely the kind of price farmers refuse to capitalise into a decade-long asset. The evidence available on 31 August 2026 does not distinguish between those readings, and this edition does not attempt to.

THE DASHBOARD

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Novorossiysk terminal throughput	Whether the three suspended terminals return to normal loading rates, and how quickly cargo queues clear.	The largest reversible component of the rally. A clean restart removes the logistics premium without any change in the crop, testing how much of the move was weather rather than war.
USDA WASDE, 11 September 2026	The first official global supply and demand estimate to incorporate the European drought and the August disruption in full.	It converts anecdote into a stocks-to-use number. A meaningful cut to global ending stocks makes the shortage structural; a modest one implies the worst is priced.
FOMC decision, 15–16 September 2026	Whether the Committee raises, having moved market-implied odds above evens after the Jackson Hole remarks.	A hike into a supply-driven food shock tightens input affordability and the cost of carrying grain inventory, working against the sector when its output price is strongest.
European TTF gas and ammonia spreads	Whether gas near €69/MWh persists, and whether European producers resume curtailing ammonia to technical minimums.	It determines which half of the nitrogen industry captures the price. Feedstock-advantaged producers gain; European producers may find imported ammonia cheaper than their own.
Fertiliser volumes, not benchmark prices	Whether tonnage moved by Nutrien, Mosaic and CF recovers in the third quarter, having been the binding constraint in the second.	The second-quarter lesson was that volume decided earnings while price did not. If volumes recover the affordability thesis is working; if not, growers are deferring applications despite the revenue.
	Whether large-agriculture order books turn, and whether the "bottom of the	

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Deere fiscal Q4, late November 2026	cycle" language survives the following quarter.	The cleanest read on whether farmers treat the 2026 grain price as durable. Machinery orders are a statement of belief about the next decade, and therefore the honest test.

THREE WAYS TO HOLD THE VIEW

Three postures, not one answer

Own the shortage itself

Direct exposure to the grain price and the logistics that clear it. The purest expression of the thesis, and the only one that captures the full move. **The cost:** the position is long a war and a drought simultaneously. Both can end on a headline, neither has an earnings floor underneath it, and the thesis reverses when the terminals reopen.

Own the input that becomes affordable

Nitrogen and potash producers, weighted to feedstock-advantaged geographies, on the argument that higher revenue per acre funds heavier application next season. **The cost:** this is a short natural-gas position in agricultural clothing. It also assumes volume follows price, which the second quarter of 2026 flatly contradicted.

Own the trough, not the spike

Agricultural machinery at a cycle bottom management has itself named, on the view that the grain move eventually reaches the order book. **The cost:** patience with no catalyst. The rally has delivered nothing here for eight months, the segment is still contracting, and the next honest test is late November.

The companies named below are illustrative of the mechanics discussed in this edition. They are NOT recommendations to buy, sell or hold any security. They were selected because their published results demonstrate the divergence this edition describes — not because any view is held on their valuation, prospects or suitability for any portfolio.

DE

Prod. & Precision Ag net sales −6%
21 Aug 2026

Deere & Company

Third-quarter fiscal 2026 net income of $1.379 billion, or $5.10 a share, on revenue of $12.61 billion, against consensus near $4.69 and $10.81 billion. The beat was emphatic and the shares rose sharply. The composition was the story: Production and Precision Agriculture sales fell 6 per cent to $3.998 billion on lower volumes in South America and Europe, while construction and small agriculture carried the quarter. Full-year guidance was raised to $4.75–5.00 billion, with management framing fiscal 2026 as likely the cycle bottom.

WATCH NEXT

> Fiscal fourth-quarter results in late November — specifically whether large-agriculture order intake responds to eight months of higher grain prices.

MOS

Q2 net loss −$273m
Aug 2026

The Mosaic Company

Second-quarter 2026 revenue of $2.8 billion with an operating loss of $36 million and a net loss of $273 million; adjusted EBITDA $407 million, adjusted earnings $0.13 a share. Phosphate moved 1.4 million tonnes for a $104 million operating loss, with sulphur availability and curtailments cited across Phosphate and the Brazilian Fertilizantes business. Potash was the profitable segment, at 2.0 million tonnes and $195 million operating. Capital expenditure was cut to $1.2 billion to preserve liquidity.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether sulphur availability normalises and phosphate curtailments end, since the loss was a cost and volume event rather than a price event.

CF

Q2 net earnings $727m volumes −15%
Aug 2026

CF Industries Holdings

Second-quarter net earnings attributable to common stockholders of $727 million, or $4.73 a diluted share, with adjusted EBITDA of $1.19 billion. Net sales rose to $2.22 billion from $1.89 billion. Selling prices were higher across all segments on a tight global nitrogen balance the company said was further tightened by supply disruptions related to the conflict with Iran. Even so, the quarter missed consensus and the shares slipped: pricing was offsetting a 15 per cent decline in volumes.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether volumes recover in the third quarter, and whether the raised $2.9 billion mid-cycle EBITDA target survives a normalisation in energy markets.

NTR

Q2 earnings and adj. EBITDA lower y/y
Aug 2026

Nutrien Ltd.

Reported that second-quarter 2026 net earnings and adjusted EBITDA decreased year on year, as higher global fertiliser benchmarks were more than offset by lower volumes and increased sulphur costs. The first half was better, with earnings up on benchmarks, stronger retail contribution and record potash sales volumes. Management called global potash markets constructive on affordability, demand and stable supply, with shipments forecast at 74–77 million tonnes for 2026. The clearest illustration that a rising benchmark is not a rising profit.

WATCH NEXT

> Third-quarter fertiliser volumes and the sulphur cost line, which together decided the second quarter more than any benchmark did.

ADM

Q2 adj. EPS $1.84 +98% y/y
Aug 2026

Archer-Daniels-Midland

Second-quarter 2026 adjusted earnings of $1.84 a share, up 98 per cent year on year and roughly 30 per cent above the $1.42 consensus. Margin expansion came from Ag Services, North American crushing and ethanol, with global oilseed processed volumes up close to 5 per cent. Crushing margins benefited from domestic demand linked to renewable volume obligations and from elevated energy prices. Full-year guidance was raised to approximately $5.15–5.60 a share from $4.15–4.70. The driver was energy policy and crude, not the wheat price.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether crush margins hold if grain input costs keep rising while crude retreats — the two legs have moved together and need not continue to.

BG

Q2 adj. EPS $2.00 vs $1.31 y/y
Aug 2026

Bunge Global

Adjusted earnings of $2.00 a share for the quarter ended 30 June 2026, against $1.31 a year earlier and consensus of $1.95, with full-year adjusted earnings guidance raised to $9.25–9.75 from $9.00–9.50. The company attributed the strength to crush margins, and specifically to soybean oil prices rising sharply as crude oil climbed on the supply disruption caused by the Iran conflict. For the world's largest oilseed processor, the profitable variable in a grain-shock quarter turned out to be the price of a barrel rather than the price of a bushel.

WATCH NEXT

> The soybean oil to crude relationship. Brent above $90 on 31 August after renewed Hormuz fighting supports the spread; a de-escalation removes it.

The bottom line

What was repriced in August 2026 was the cost of moving wheat out of the Black Sea, compounded by a genuinely poor Northern Hemisphere harvest. What was not repriced — and this is the substance of the edition — is the earnings power of the businesses sitting around the crop. A fertiliser producer reported a $273 million loss. Another saw earnings fall despite higher benchmarks. A third beat on price and missed on volume. The machinery manufacturer's farming segment contracted 6 per cent. The two processors that did prosper prospered because crude oil rose, not because grain did. Eight months of a 54.5 per cent move in wheat has so far produced no coherent windfall anywhere in the listed complex — which is what a supply shock, as opposed to a demand expansion, should be expected to produce.

The evidence is mixed, and it would be dishonest to present it otherwise. Physical impairment at Novorossiysk is real, the European drought cannot be repaired within the marketing year, and CF Industries is underwriting nitrogen tightness through 2030 with the balance sheet to match. Against that, the second-quarter results season demonstrated that volume and input cost, not benchmark price, decided who earned money — and the USDA's own pre-spike forecast had real farm income falling with a 45 per cent increase in government transfers holding it up. The reasonable inference is that the grain move is, for now, a redistribution inside the sector rather than an expansion of it, and that the equity complex has been pricing that distinction correctly rather than missing it. The next test is narrow and dated: the WASDE on 11 September will say whether global ending stocks have structurally tightened, and Deere's fourth quarter in late November will say whether any farmer believed the price enough to buy a tractor on the strength of it.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal sources. None available. The Heyokha research Wiki MCP server was absent from this session: no *list_sources*, *list_pages*, *get_page*, *get_relations* or *search_wiki* tool could be loaded, and a search of the connected Notion workspace returned no corresponding theme, source-summary or company pages. There is therefore no Wiki slug, no created or last-reviewed date, and no research-provider issue — 13D Research, White Box, Greed & Fear, Solid Ground, Marc Faber, HS Dent, Gary Shilling or otherwise — underlying any statement here. The internal leg of the house method did not run.

(b) Limitation on the internal view. This paragraph would normally name the provider concentration on the relevant Wiki page and discount the internal argument accordingly. Today the limitation is total rather than partial: with no internal view at all, the customary counterweight between a provider's thesis and the external record is absent. Everything here is external reporting and company disclosure, which carries its own bias — company results describe the past, and news reporting over-weights the datable and the dramatic. The argument should be read as built from the outside in, with no house thesis behind it. The opening sidebar reframe is editorial, not a provider view.

(c) External sources. (1) **Wheat:** settled 784c/bushel on 28 August 2026, +3.1 per cent on the day after a 790.25 high, +12.1 per cent on the week (largest since March 2022), highest since 14 February 2023, +54.5 per cent year to date — CNBC and exchange settlement reporting, 28 August 2026. Continuation-series quotations for the same date circulate at 766c on a different contract basis; the settlement figure is used here. (2) **Corn:** three-year high above $5.40/bushel; +6 per cent week, +16 per cent August, +22 per cent 2026 — market reporting, 28 August 2026. (3) **Soybeans:** September $12.64¼, November $12.76¾, highest since May 2024; +3 per cent week, +7 per cent August, +22 per cent 2026; 333,000-tonne Chinese purchase announced 26 August; US corn conditions 57 per cent good/excellent — market and USDA Crop Progress reporting, 26–28 August 2026. (4) **Novorossiysk:** Ukrainian drone strike overnight 11–12 August 2026, three killed; Novorossiysk Grain Terminal (8.5Mt annual capacity) suspended, all three terminals including KSK suspended by 13 August; up to one third of Russian grain exports route through the port; Russia and Ukraine together exceed a quarter of world wheat exports — Reuters, S&P Global, Al Jazeera, CNBC, 12–13 August 2026. (5) **France:** 2026 wheat production near 32Mt, down close to 7 per cent year on year, drought in Germany, Romania, Poland — French agriculture ministry as reported, 2026. (6) **Deere,** Q3 FY2026, quarter ended 2 August, reported 21 August 2026: net income $1.379bn, $5.10/share, revenue $12.61bn vs consensus $4.69 and $10.81bn; Production and Precision Agriculture net sales $3.998bn, −6 per cent; FY guidance $4.75–

5.00bn. (7) **Mosaic,** Q2 2026: revenue $2.8bn, operating loss $36m, net loss $273m, adjusted EBITDA $407m, adjusted EPS $0.13; Phosphate 1.4Mt and −$104m operating; Potash 2.0Mt and $195m operating; Fertilizantes 1.5Mt and −$41m operating; FY capex cut to $1.2bn from $1.25bn — 8-K and results release, August 2026. (8) **CF Industries,** Q2 2026: net earnings $727m, $4.73/diluted share; EBITDA $1.17bn, adjusted EBITDA $1.19bn; net sales $2.22bn vs $1.89bn; H1 net earnings $1.34bn and adjusted EBITDA $2.18bn; H1 ammonia utilisation 98 per cent; consensus missed with pricing offsetting a 15 per cent volume decline; mid-cycle EBITDA target raised to $2.9bn with nitrogen tightness expected through 2030 — release and earnings call, 5–12 August 2026. (9) **Nutrien,** Q2 2026: net earnings and adjusted EBITDA decreased year on year as higher benchmarks were more than offset by lower volumes and increased sulphur costs; H1 higher on benchmarks, retail and record potash volumes; global potash shipments forecast 74–77Mt for 2026 — results release. (10) **ADM,** Q2 2026: adjusted EPS $1.84, +98 per cent year on year, vs $1.42 consensus; oilseed processed volumes up close to 5 per cent; FY adjusted EPS guidance raised to approximately $5.15–5.60 from $4.15–4.70 — results and earnings call, 4 August 2026. (11) **Bunge,** quarter ended 30 June 2026: adjusted EPS $2.00 vs $1.31 and $1.95 consensus; FY guidance raised to $9.25–9.75 from $9.00–9.50; strength attributed to soybean oil following crude higher after Iran-related disruption — results and Reuters reporting. (12) Sell-side framing that nitrogen producers would outperform potash and phosphate peers — Reuters, 4–5 May 2026. (13) **USDA ERS,** February 2026 forecast: 2026 net farm income $153.4bn, −0.7 per cent nominal and lower in real terms; crop cash receipts $240.8bn, +1.2 per cent nominal and −0.7 per cent real; corn receipts $63.67bn, +3.3 per cent; soybean receipts $44.5bn, flat; direct government payments $44.3bn, +45.2 per cent from $30.5bn. (14) **Pass-through:** farm share of the consumer food dollar approximately 16 cents in aggregate and 24 cents for grocery food; a 20 per cent rise in farm commodity costs adds at most four to five cents per grocery dollar; typical lag from agricultural futures to CPI food-at-home three to six months, extending to twelve for seasonally stored, flour-based and canned goods — USDA ERS and Purdue University Center for Commercial Agriculture, 2026. (15) **Warsh,** Jackson Hole, 28 August 2026: underlying inflation trends have not meaningfully improved; "We must be confident that underlying inflation is moving to our objective, clearly and at sufficient speed… Otherwise, we have work to do." Market-implied odds of a 15–16 September increase rose from roughly one in three to above 50 per cent — CNBC, NPR, Washington Post. (16) **Energy:** European TTF gas near €69.44/MWh on 28 August 2026; LAT Nitrogen reduced ammonia output to technical minimum in March 2026 on feedstock costs — S&P Global and market data. (17) Brent November crude above $90 and WTI near $86 in early Asian trading on 31 August 2026 after US strikes on Iranian rocket launchers in the Strait of Hormuz; S&P 500 closed −0.3 per cent on 28 August, +0.5 per cent on the week — Bloomberg, 30–31 August 2026. (18) September WASDE scheduled 11 September 2026, 12:00 ET — USDA report calendar.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. *Topic selection.* The Wiki entity-scoring procedure could not run, so the topic was chosen from the hot external signal: wheat's 12.1 per cent weekly move to a three-year high was the largest single commodity event of the week to 28 August 2026, and the grain complex is the one major theme entirely absent from the archive. *Cooldown.* This ran in full and successfully — the archive folder was read directly and every filename parsed. The thirty-day cooldown set comprises AI Capex, Copper, Gold Miners, Grid Equipment, Oil & Gas, Software Unit Economics, Healthcare Rotation, Tanker Shipping, Uranium, Oil Chokepoint Risk, Seat-Based Software, Energy Chokepoints, Copper Smelting Bottleneck, Fiscal Dominance, China Equities, Memory Supercycle, Rare Earth Magnets, Gold, Humanoid Robots, Iran War and Coal. Grain Supply Shock appears nowhere in the archive at any date. The Hormuz escalation of 30–31 August, otherwise the obvious topic, was excluded because Iran War (27 August), Energy Chokepoints (14 August) and Oil Chokepoint Risk (12 August) are all on cooldown; it appears here only as context. *Tool failures.* The Heyokha Wiki MCP server was absent from the session entirely. The Fiscal.ai connector was available but its free tier covers only 100 companies, none agricultural, so no company figure here derives from it; all company figures come from published results releases and earnings-call reporting. Direct HTTP fetching and yfinance are blocked in this environment and were not attempted as workarounds. One fetch of the CNBC grain article returned an empty body, so its figures come from the search-result extract rather than the full article, and the resulting contract-basis discrepancy is disclosed at note (1). Share-price levels were deliberately omitted from the ticker cards in favour of verified operational figures, because reliable dated closing prices for the six names could not be confirmed.
